

For both of these assignments, you will write up as much material as possible in class. At the end of class, you can take a picture of it with your phone before I collect it, scan it, and email it to you that evening. You can work on (rearrange, refine) this in-class material on your own as homework, but you should try to stay as close as you can to the in-class material you wrote. Do not use LLMs or any other so-called “artificial intelligence”: this is a writing class, after all! Sometime before the deadline, turn in a PDF or DOC file via Canvas: if you want to play it safe you can *also* send it to my email address (scm244@cornell.edu).

Deadline: Friday September 11th 10pm

Writing Assignment #1a

In the early sections of *Leviathan* Chapter 15, Thomas Hobbes presents and replies to a line of reasoning attributed to “the fool”.

(A) What is the general topic being discussed? What is the specific topic being discussed?

This should be at least 200 words.

(B) What is the fool’s line of reasoning? Try to find any argumentation that can be presented in a numbered premise-conclusion format, and provide your own reconstruction in this format.

This should be at least 300 words (including any argument reconstruction).

(C) What is Hobbes’s reply to the fool? Again, try to find any argumentation that can be presented in a numbered premise-conclusion format, and provide your own reconstruction in this format.

This should be at least 500 words (including any argument reconstruction).

NOTE: For purposes of this writing assignment, please ignore the small and specific bits discussing gaining heavenly bliss and gaining political power.

Writing Assignment #1b

In Book I of Plato’s *Republic*, Socrates provides a preliminary argument against Thrasymachus’s newly refined “in the precise sense” account of justice. This argument runs from 341c (“Tell me: is a doctor...”) to 343a (“it was clear to all that [Thrasymachus’s] account of justice had turned into its opposite”).

Provide your own detailed reconstruction of this argument in numbered premise-conclusion format. You can make one huge argument, or you can break it up into smaller sub-arguments (where the conclusion of one sub-argument serves as a premise in the next sub-argument).

This should be at least 300 words.

Be sure that your reconstruction includes the following material in some form:

- crafts and bringing advantage to something/someone (i.e. some beneficiary)
- whether a craft can seek its own advantage
- the quick argumentation occurring from 342a–b (“so that... And... Or... Or...”)
- “stronger” and “weaker” comparisons
- a conclusion in which the account has (in some sense) “turned into its opposite”

NOTE: In this passage, the English words “ruler”, “rule”, and “subject” all translate Greek words that are very closely related, so that “subject” is basically equivalent to “ruled”.

You can also add clarifying comments, but they won’t count towards, or help you meet, the 300 word requirement.